INCH-POUND

MIL-B-43750H
10 September 1993
SUPERSEDING
MIL-B-43750G
29 June 1984

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

BEEF WITH RICE, COOKED, DEHYDRATED

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers dehydrated, cooked beef with rice for use by the Department of Defense as a component of operational rations.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-1898	-	Cushioning Material, Cellulosic, Packaging
L-P-378	-	Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin
QQ-A-1876	-	Aluminum Foil
PPP-B-26	-	Bag, Plastic, (General Purpose)

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be used in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5018, by using the Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8940

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PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard
PPP-C-29 - Canned Subsistence Items, Packaging and Packing of
PPP-C-1752 - Cushioning Material, Packaging, Unicellular Polyethylene Foam, Flexible
PPP-C-1797 - Cushioning Material, Resilient, Low Density, Unicellular, Polypropylene Foam
PPP-T-60 - Tape: Packaging, Waterproof

MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preparation of Nonperishable Subsistence Items, General Specification for

STANDARDS

FEDERAL

FED-STD-595 - Colors Used in Government Procurement

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

ENVIRONMENTAL PROTECTION AGENCY (EPA)

National Primary Drinking Water Regulations

(Copies are available from the Office of Drinking Water, Environmental Protection Agency, WH550D, 401 M Street, S.W., Washington, DC 20460.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF AGRICULTURE (USDA)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations (9 CFR Part 301-391)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

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Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications for Fresh Beef, Series 100

(Copies are available from the Chief, Livestock and Meat Standardization Branch, Livestock and Seed Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2603, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Condition of Food Containers

(Copies are available from the Chairperson, Condition of Container Committee, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2506, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Instant Nonfat Dry Milk (7 CFR Part 58)

(Copies are available from the Dairy Standardization Branch, Dairy Division, Agricultural Marketing Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, Room 2750, South Building, P.O. Box 96456, Washington, DC 20090-6456.)

U.S. Standards for Milled Rice (7 CFR Part 68)

(Copies are available from the Federal Grain Inspection Service, Animal and Plant Health Inspection, Printing and Distribution Section, G-100 Federal Building, Hyattsville, MD 20782.)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES (HHS), U.S. FOOD AND DRUG ADMINISTRATION (FDA)

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated thereunder (21 CFR Parts 1-199)

(Copies are available from the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402-0001.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DoD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.1).

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION OF CEREAL CHEMISTS (AACC)

Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Cereal Chemists, 3340 Pilot Knob Road, St. Paul, MN 55121.)

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AMERICAN DEHYDRATED ONION AND GARLIC ASSOCIATION (ADOGA)

Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association, One Maritime Plaza, 23rd Floor, San Francisco, CA 94111.)

AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 1238 - Flow Rates of Thermoplastic by Extrusion Plastometer
D 1505 - Density of Plastics by Density Gradient Technique

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

AOAC INTERNATIONAL

Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC

(Application for copies should be addressed to the AOAC International, 2200 Wilson Boulevard, Suite 400, Arlington, VA 22201-3301.)

NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES

Food Chemicals Codex

(Application for copies should be addressed to the National Academy Press, 2101 Constitution Avenue, N.W., Washington, DC 20418.)

THE UNITED STATES PHARMACOPOEIAL CONVENTION, INC.

The United States Pharmacopoeia (USP) and the National Formulary (NF)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the United States Pharmacopoeial Convention, Inc., 12601 Twinbrook Parkway, Rockville, MD 20852.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

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3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.2) in accordance with 4.4.

3.2 Ingredients. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from foreign material, evidence of rodent or insect infestation, extraneous material, off-odors, off-flavors, and off-colors.

3.2.1 Beef, ground. The beef shall be from steers, heifers, or cows and shall meet the requirements of the USDA Certified Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications (IMPs) for Item No. 137 - Ground Beef, Special. Final grinding shall be through a plate having holes 3/8 inch (± 1/16 inch) in diameter. The fat content shall be not less than 12.0 percent nor more than 23.0 percent (see 4.5.2.1). All beef shipped between plants shall be certified by a USDA Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS) agent to certify condition of the product, the initial chill or freezing (in-storage) date, and compliance with the Institutional Meat Purchase Specifications Quality Assurance Provisions. Handling and storage of the beef shall comply with 3.2.1.1 and 3.2.1.2.

3.2.1.1 Beef, ground, chilled. Ground beef received in the chilled state shall have been held at an internal temperature of 28°F to 40°F for a period not to exceed 72 hours following initial chilling and prior to product preparation.

3.2.1.2 Beef, ground, frozen. Ground beef received in the frozen state shall have been held at a temperature of 0°F or below for a period not to exceed 120 days following initial freezing and prior to product preparation. The frozen ground beef shall have been:

- frozen to 0°F or lower within 72 hours after initial certification
- protected from freezer deterioration and damage
- stored in containers that are adequate to maintain product excellence

3.2.2 Rice, long-grain, precooked, instant. Rice shall be pre-cooked, long-grain, milled rice, U.S. No. 2 or better of the United States Standards for Milled Rice and shall be of such varieties which are suitable for further processing (7 CFR Part 68). The instant rice shall have a smooth surface and remain whole in the final product.

3.2.3 Milk, nonfat, dry, instant. The instant, nonfat, dry milk shall be U.S. Extra grade as defined in the United States Standards for Instant Nonfat Dry Milk (7 CFR Part 58).

3.2.4 Shortening, powdered, vegetable. Powdered, vegetable shortening shall be spray dried, free flowing, and free of any scorching. The shortening shall be composed of partially hydrogenated vegetable oil, sodium

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caseinate, corn syrup solids, soy protein isolate, dipotassium phosphate, sodium silico-aluminate, tricalcium phosphate, with or without an antioxidant and shall have the following typical analyses:

Total oil	75.0 ± 2.5%
Protein	5.5 ± 0.5%
Carbohydrate	16.0 ± 1.0%
Moisture	1.5 ± 0.5%
Ash	2.0 ± 1.0%

3.2.5 Starch, waxy maize, modified, pregelatinized, instant. The starch shall be a pure, off-white, odorless, slightly coarse, ground powder. It shall be modified, pregelatinized, cross-linked and stabilized. The starch shall have a maximum moisture content of 9.0 percent and a pH of 4.0 to 6.5. The starch shall be resistant to breakdown under high temperature, heating conditions, have good, low temperature stability and shall not set to a gel. The starch shall display good clarity and a smooth, short textured, heavy body. The starch shall be bland with no objectionable off-notes.

3.2.6 Salt. Salt shall be white, refined sodium chloride with or without anticaking agents, and shall comply with the purity standards for sodium chloride of the Food Chemicals Codex.

3.2.7 Onions, chopped, dehydrated. Dehydrated, chopped onions shall be Fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.8 Onion powder. Onion powder shall be Fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

3.2.9 Soup stock, dehydrated. Dehydrated soup stock shall be a light brown to tan colored, free-flowing powder derived from soup stock produced from USDA inspected beef bones with adhering meat. The dehydrated soup stock shall have a minimum of 93.0 percent total solids and a maximum of 2.0 percent fat. There shall be no added salt in the product.

3.2.10 Pepper, black, ground. Ground, black pepper shall have been ground from the deep brown to black, deep-set, wrinkled, immature berries of Piper nigrum L. The ground pepper shall have a characteristic, penetrating odor, a hot, biting, pungent flavor and a light gray to speckled, black-gray color. The ground pepper shall contain not less than 2.0 mL of volatile oil per 100 grams of ground black pepper and be of such size that 95 percent shall pass through a U.S. Standard No. 16 sieve.

3.2.11 Garlic powder. Garlic powder shall be Fancy grade of the Official Standards and Methods of the American Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Association (ADOGA) for Dehydrated Onion and Garlic Products.

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3.2.12 Flavoring, soluble, celery. Soluble celery flavoring shall be prepared by blending and dispersing a minimum of 4 percent of total extractives of the dried fruit of Apium graveolens L. and a soluble, dry, edible carrier. The flavoring shall possess a clean, celery-like aroma with a slightly bitter taste. The flavoring shall be free-flowing, yellowish-gray in color and free of caking.

3.2.13 Water. Water used for formulation and blanching shall conform to the National Primary Drinking Water Regulations.

3.2.14 Nitrogen. Nitrogen shall meet the requirements of the United States Pharmacopeia and shall be water or liquid nitrogen pumped.

3.2.15 Preblended spice and seasoning mix. Preblended spices and seasonings may be used. The spices and seasonings in the mix shall comply with the individual requirements specified in this document. The containers used for the spice and seasoning blend shall be labeled with each ingredient and the percentage of each ingredient in the blend. The ingredients shall be in the same proportions as specified in the spice and seasoning mix formula (see 3.3.1).

3.3 Preparation and processing. Processing shall be on a continuous basis.

3.3.1 Spice and seasoning mix preparation. The spice and seasoning mix shall be a uniform blend of the following ingredients:

Ingredient	Percent by Weight
Salt	36.0
Onions, chopped, dehydrated	30.0
Onion powder	22.4
Soup stock, dehydrated	5.2
Pepper, black, ground	3.6
Garlic powder	2.0
Flavoring, celery, soluble	0.8

3.3.2 Product preparation. The beef with rice shall be formulated and prepared as follows:

Ingredient	Percent by Weight
Water	46.9
Beef, raw, ground	35.0
Rice, long-grain, precooked, instant	11.3
Spice and seasoning mix	2.5
Mix, nonfat, dry, instant	1.9
Shortening, powdered, vegetable	1.4
Starch, pregelatinized, instant	1.0

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NOTE: The following product preparation procedures were used in the development of this product. Alternative procedures may be used provided finished product requirements are met. When alternative procedures are used, the time and temperature requirements specified for the prepared product are still applicable.

a. The instant nonfat dry milk shall be reconstituted using part of the formula water.

b. A slurry shall be prepared from the starch and part of the formula water.

c. The spice and seasoning mix, shortening, and remaining water shall be added to the slurry, mixed, and brought to a temperature of 180°F to 190°F. The sauce shall be mixed thoroughly.

d. The ground beef shall be added and heated with continuous stirring until the meat is fully cooked (brown with no visible, pink color).

e. The rice and rehydrated milk shall be added and mixed only to the extent necessary to assure a uniform blend of the ingredients. The mixture shall be heated to 160°F to 180°F and allowed to stand until the rice is just cooked (approximately 5 minutes). Rice shall remain whole in the finished product.

f. Product shall be spread on dehydrator trays immediately after the completion of the cooking process.

3.4 Freezing. The prepared product shall be spread on dehydrator trays and cooled immediately, placed in a freezer within 4 hours after cooking, and frozen to 0°F below within 6 hours after being placed in the freezer. The frozen product shall be maintained at 0°F or lower at all times prior to freeze dehydration and shall be freeze dehydrated within 5 days after freezing.

3.5 Dehydration. The product shall be freeze dehydrated at an absolute pressure not to exceed 1.5 mm of mercury and at a product temperature as indicated by suitable instruments, not to exceed 150°F. If the platen temperature is maintained at 155°F or below with radiant heating, the product temperature may be disregarded. After dehydration is completed, the pressure shall be equalized to atmospheric level with nitrogen and the product shall be packaged as specified in 5.1. In no case shall more than 16 hours elapse between the time the chamber is opened and the time the product is completely packaged. During the interim, the product shall be adequately protected from oxygen and moisture by either holding under a nitrogen atmosphere with 2.0 percent or less oxygen, or under a vacuum of at least 27 inches of mercury for the entire period. If a vacuum is used, it shall be broken with nitrogen.

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3.6 Pouch and mixing bag filling and sealing. Each pouch and mixing bag shall be filled and sealed with product such as to conform to the finished product requirements and to the requirements specified in 5.1.1.

3.7 Finished product requirements.

3.7.1 Dehydrated product. The dehydrated product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, glass, or metal.

b. There shall be no foreign odor or flavor, such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, or stale.

c. There shall be no color foreign to the product.

d. There shall be no evidence of incomplete dehydration such as wet or soft spots.

e. There shall be no evidence of faulty dehydration such as glazed surface areas or burnt areas measuring more than 0.5 inch in any dimension or dark colored cores of any dimension.

f. At least 50 percent by weight of the product tested shall be retained on a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve.

g. The moisture content of the dehydrated product shall not exceed 2.0 percent.

h. The individual net weight shall be not less than 120 grams for the Ration, Cold Weather (RCW) pouch and shall be not less than 140 grams for the Long Range Patrol (LRP) pouch.

i. The aerobic plate count shall be not greater than 75,000 per gram in four of five samples, and not greater than 150,000 per gram in any sample.

j. The E. coli count shall be less than 3 per gram (no positives in the standard 3 tube MPN technique) in four of five samples and not greater than 10 per gram in any sample.

3.7.2 Rehydrated product. Rehydration shall be in accordance with the specified instructions in 4.5.6. The rehydrated product shall comply with the following requirements:

a. The rehydrated product shall show complete water penetration through all particles. However, gristle and similar materials in the meat do not necessarily rehydrate properly and such materials shall not be considered as evidence of incomplete rehydration.

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b. The rehydrated product shall possess the flavor, odor, and texture considered normal for cooked, frozen and reheated beef with rice.

c. The total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, shall be not more than 9 grams per 120 grams (RCW) or 10 grams per 140 grams (LRP) of dehydrated product which has been rehydrated.

d. No individual pouch shall contain a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension.

3.7.3 Palatability. The finished product shall be equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample (see 6.1) in palatability and overall appearance.

3.8 Plant qualification. The beef component and the finished product shall originate and be produced, processed, and stored in plants regularly operating under Meat and Poultry Products Inspection Regulations of the U.S. Department of Agriculture.

3.9 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Contractor's responsibility. Inspection and acceptance by the USDA shall not relieve the contractor of obligation and responsibility to deliver a product complying with all requirements of this specification. The contractor shall ensure product compliance prior to submitting the product to the USDA for any inspection.

4.2 Inspection and certification. Product acceptability shall be determined by the USDA. The USDA will determine the degree of inspection and supervision necessary to ensure compliance with the requirements of this specification.

4.3 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.4).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.5).

4.4 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 6.1), it shall be inspected in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of this specification and evaluated for overall appearance and palatability. Any failure to conform to the quality assurance provisions of this specification or any appearance or palatability failure shall be cause for rejection of the first article.

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4.5 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.5.1 Component and material examination. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be examined in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.5.1.1 Ingredient and component examination. Conformance of ingredients and components to identity, condition, and other requirements specified in 3.2 shall be certified by the ingredient supplier or ingredient manufacturer, and compliance shall be verified by examination of pertinent labels, markings, U.S. Grade Certificates, certificates of analyses, or other such valid documents acceptable to the inspection agency. If necessary, each ingredient shall be examined organoleptically or inspected according to generally recognized test methods, such as the methods described in the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC and in the Approved Methods of the American Association of Cereal Chemists, to determine conformance to the requirements. Any nonconformance to an identity, condition, or other requirement shall be cause for rejection of the ingredient or component lot or of any involved product.

4.5.1.2 Mixing bag, baseboard, and pouch material certification. Material listed below may be accepted on the basis of a contractor's certificate of conformance to the indicated requirements. In addition, compliance to the requirements for inside pouch dimensions and dimensions of manufacturer's seals may be verified by a certificate of conformance.

Requirement	Requirement paragraph	Test procedure
Mixing bag material identification	5.1.1.1	Laboratory evaluation
Baseboard (when used)	5.1.1.1.2	Laboratory evaluation
Thickness of films for laminated material	5.1.1.2	As specified in L-P-378, except that a machinist's micrometer may be used provided that its graduations and accuracy conform to the requirements of L-P-378
Aluminum foil thickness	5.1.1.2	As specified in QQ-A-1876
Laminated material identification and construction	5.1.1.2	Laboratory evaluation
Color of laminated material	5.1.1.2	Visual evaluation

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4.5.1.3 Unfilled mixing bag examination. The unfilled mixing bags shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one mixing bag. The inspection level shall be S-4 and the acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects.

TABLE I. Unfilled mixing bag defects

Category	Defect
Major	
101	Not formed as specified
102	Inside dimensions not as specified
103	Tear, hole, or open seal
104	Bags stick together
105	Not clean
106	Foreign odor

4.5.1.4 Unfilled mixing bag leakage testing. Eight unfilled mixing bags shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of lot size and shall be tested for leakage as follows: Each sample bag shall be filled with eight ounces of boiling water (being careful not to spill any water on the outside) and suspended 8 to 12 inches above a sheet of clean paper for 10 minutes. Any moisture on the paper attributable to bag leakage shall be classified as a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in bags. The sample unit shall be one bag. The finding of any defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be performed to determine conformance to the preparation, processing, filling, sealing, and packaging requirements. Any nonconformance revealed by actual examination or by review of records of time, temperature, and formulation, or of other valid documents shall be cause for rejection of the involved product.

4.5.2.1 In-process testing for fat content. Four 1 pound samples shall be selected at random from the day's production of raw ground beef. Each of the four samples shall be tested for fat content in accordance with the Official Methods of the AOAC, method 960.39, 976.21 or 985.15. Results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the fat content requirement in 3.2.1 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot of ground beef or any product made therefrom.

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4.5.3 Net weight examination.

4.5.3.1 Net weight examination of pouches. The net weight of the filled and sealed pouches shall be determined by weighing each sample unit on a suitable scale tared with a representative empty mixing bag and pouch. Any individual net weight of less than 120 grams for a RCW pouch, or less than 140 grams for a LRP pouch, shall be classified as a minor defect. Results shall be reported to the nearest gram. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 2.5.

4.5.4 Filled and sealed pouch examination. The filled and sealed pouches shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects.

TABLE II. Filled and sealed pouch defects 1/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
101		Tear, cut, hole, or abrasion through one or more layers in the pouch material or leakage through any heat seal 2/
102		Foldover wrinkle extending into the seal such that the effective closure seal is reduced to less than 1/16 inch 3/
103		Evidence of entrapped product that reduces the effective closure seal to less than 1/16 inch 3/
104		Presence of delamination 4/
105		Unclean pouch 5/
106		Labeling is missing, incorrect, or illegible
107		Any impression or design on the heat seal surfaces which conceals or impairs visual detection of seal defects 6/
108		Less than 3/16 inch between inside edge of tear notch and inside edge of seal
109		Closure seal width not as specified

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TABLE II. Filled and sealed pouch defects 1/ (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	
110		Closure seal not located as specified
	201	Tear notch(es) or serrations missing or not located as specified
	202	Depth of tear notch(es) or serrations not as specified
	203	Presence of delamination 4/

1/ Any evidence of rodent or insect infestation shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Pinholes or breaks inherent to the manufacturing process of the aluminum foil shall not be scored as a defect.

3/ The effective closure seal is defined as any uncontaminated, fusion bonded, continuous path, minimum 1/16 inch wide, from side seal to side seal that produces a hermetically sealed pouch.

4/ Delamination defect classification:

Major - Delamination of the outer ply in the pouch seal area that can be propagated to expose aluminum foil at the food product edge of the pouch after manual flexing of the delaminated area. To flex, the delaminated area shall be held between the thumb and forefinger of each hand with both thumbs and forefingers touching each other. The delaminated area shall then be rapidly flexed 10 times by rotating both hands in alternating clockwise, counter-clockwise directions. Care shall be exercised when flexing delaminated areas near the tear notches to avoid tearing the pouch material. After flexing, the separated outer ply shall be grasped between thumb and forefinger and gently lifted toward the food product edge of the seal or if the separated area is too small to be held between thumb and forefinger, a number two stylus shall be inserted into the delaminated area and a gentle lifting force applied against the outer ply. If separation of the outer ply can be made to extend to the product edge of the seal with no discernible resistance to the gentle lifting, the delamination shall be classified as a major defect. Additionally, spot delamination of the outer ply in the body of the pouch that is able to be propagated beyond its initial borders is also a major defect. To determine if the delaminated area is a defect, use the following procedure. Mark the outside edges of the delaminated area using a bold, permanent marking pen. Open the pouch and remove the contents. Cut the

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pouch transversely not closer than 1/4 inch (± 1/16 inch) from the delaminated area. The pouch shall be flexed in the area in question using the procedure described above. Any propaga- tion of the delaminated area, as evidenced by the delaminated area exceeding the limits of the outlined borders, shall be classified as a major defect.

Minor - Minor delamination of the outer ply in the pouch seal area is acceptable and shall not be classified as a minor defect unless it extends to within 1/16 inch of the food product edge of the seal. All other minor outer ply delamination in the pouch seal area or isolated spots of delamination in the body of the pouch that do not propagate when flexed as described above shall be classified as minor defects.

5/ Outer packaging shall be free from foreign matter which is unwholesome, has the potential to cause pouch damage (for example, glass, metal filings) or generally detracts from the clean appearance of the package. The following examples shall not be scored as defects for unclean:

a. Foreign matter which presents no health hazard or potential pouch damage and which can be readily removed by gently shaking the package or by gently brushing the package with a clean dry cloth.

b. Dried product which affects less than 1/8 of the total surface area of one pouch face (localized and aggregate).

c. Water spots.

6/ If doubt exists as to whether or not the sealing equipment leaves an impression or design on the closure seal surface that could conceal or impair visual detection of seal defects, samples shall be furnished to the contracting officer for a determination as to acceptability.

4.5.5 Pouch vacuum examination. The filled and vacuum sealed pouches shall be visually examined for conformance to the vacuum requirement in 5.1.1.3 not less than 96 hours after filling and sealing. The sealed pouch shall continue to exhibit tight adherence to the surface contours of the contents when a pulling force is applied at the center of each side seal. This force shall be applied by holding each side seal between the thumb and forefinger of each hand, while simultaneously exerting a slight pull with both hands. Any evidence of loss of vacuum shall be classified a major defect. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be I and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 0.65.

4.5.6 Product examination. The finished product shall be examined for the defects listed in table III. The lot size shall be expressed in pouches. The sample unit shall be the contents of one filled and sealed pouch. The inspection level shall be S-3 and the AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, shall be 1.5 for major defects and 6.5 for minor defects.

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TABLE III. Product defects 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Major	Minor	Applicable to dehydrated product
101		Evidence of incomplete dehydration such as wet or soft spots
102		Presence of glazed surface areas measuring more than 0.5 inch in any dimension
103		Presence of burned areas as indicated by a black spot greater than 0.5 inch in any dimension
104		Presence of dark colored cores in any dimension
	201	Less than 50 percent of product retained on a U.S. Standard No. 8 sieve 3/
		Applicable to rehydrated product 4/
105		Incomplete water penetration through all particles 5/
106		The total weight of cartilage, coarse connective tissue, section of tendons or ligaments, and glandular material, collectively, is more than 9 grams per 120 grams (RCW) or 10 grams per 140 grams (LRP) of dehydrated product which has been rehydrated
107		Presence of a bone piece measuring 0.3 inch or more in any dimension
108		Product does not possess flavor, odor, and texture considered normal for cooked, frozen and reheated beef with rice

1/ The presence of any foreign material (for example, glass, dirt, insect parts, hair, wood, metal), foreign odor or flavor (for example, burnt, scorched, moldy, rancid, sour, stale), or foreign color shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

2/ Product not equal to or better than the approved preproduction sample in palatability or overall appearance shall be cause for rejection of the lot (see 3.7.3).

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3/ The contents of two randomly selected, 120 gram or 140 gram pouches as applicable, shall be mechanically shaken for two minutes for sieve testing.

4/ Multiply the product weight in grams by 2.6 to get milliliters of hot water for rehydration. Continue with label instructions.

5/ Dry areas attributable to gristle and similar material shall not be considered as defects.

4.5.7 Internal pressure test. Eight filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of the lot size and individually tested for internal pressure resistance. The internal pressure resistance shall be determined by pressurizing the pouches while they are restrained between two rigid plates spaced 1/2 (± 1/16) inch apart. If a three-seal tester (one that pressurizes the pouch through an open end) is used, the closure seal shall be cut off for testing of the side and bottom seals of the pouch; for testing of the closure seal, the bottom seal shall be cut off. The pouches shall be emptied prior to testing. If a four-seal tester (designed to pressurize filled pouches by use of a hypodermic needle through the pouch wall) is used, all four seals can be tested simultaneously. The distance between the rigid restraining plates on the four seal tester shall be equal to the thickness of the product (+ 1/16 inch). Pressure shall be applied at the approximate uniform rate of 1 psig per second until 14 psig pressure is reached. The 14 psig pressure shall be held constant for 30 seconds and then released. The pouches shall then be examined for separation or yield of the heat seals. Any rupture of the pouch or evidence of seal separation greater than 1/16 inch in the pouch manufacturers seals shall be considered a test failure. Any seal separation that reduces the effective closure seal width to less than 1/16 inch (see table II), shall be considered a test failure. Any test failure shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.8 Moisture content testing. Eight filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of the lot size. The contents of each pouch shall be blended to uniformity using a blender or a food processor. The blending must be rapid and conducted in such a way that minimum heat is transferred to the product and that the product has minimum exposure to atmospheric moisture. Each sample shall be individually tested for moisture content in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, method 950.46/A, except that the temperature-time cycle shall be modified by using a temperature of 70°C for 16 hours at a pressure of not more than 100 mm of mercury. Test results shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the requirement in 3.7.1 shall be considered a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.9 Microbiological testing. Five filled and sealed pouches shall be selected at random from the lot regardless of the lot size. Each sample shall be individually tested for aerobic plate count and E. coli in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC, methods 966.23

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and 966.24. The diluent shall be added to each sample of dry product and allowed to stand for 15 minutes before the blending of the sample. Continue with the procedure as directed. Any result not conforming to the microbiological requirements in 3.7.1 shall be classified as a major defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5.10 Shipping container examination. Shipping containers shall be examined for defects in assembly, closure, and reinforcement (when applicable) in accordance with PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be classified as follows:

Major: Marking missing, incorrect, or illegible
Cushioning material missing or not as specified

Minor: More than 40 pounds packed in shipping container
Pouches not packed flat in layers

4.5.11 Unit load inspection. Inspection of unit loads shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of MIL-L-35078.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A.

5.1.1 Level A. The product shall be filled into mixing bags specified in 5.1.1.1 and sealed in pouches as specified in 5.1.1.2.

5.1.1.1 Mixing bags. A net weight of 120 grams of product for the RCW or 140 grams of product for the LRP shall be filled into mixing bags fabricated from 0.003 inch thick polyethylene made in accordance with type I bags of PPP-B-26, except that the bag shall be made from food grade polyethylene. The bags shall not impart any undesirable odor or flavor to the product and shall be approved by the FDA for food use. The inside dimensions of the bag shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 by 8 inches (± 1/8 inch in each dimension) with the open end of the bag having the 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch dimensions. After filling, the side panels of the bag (corresponding to the 3-1/2 inch dimension) shall be folded in to form gussets, and the bag shall be closed by folding over its open end. Where required by the bulkiness of the product, the bulk of the contents within the bag shall be compressed such that the product thickness is not less than 2-1/4 inches by applying a constant uniform pressure over the entire top surface of the bag. The open top of the filled bag shall be folded over to prevent spillage of the product. Alternatively, polyethylene bags conforming to type II of PPP-B-26, with inside dimensions of 9 inches by 8 inches (± 1/8 inch in each dimension) with the open end of the bag having the 9 inch dimension, may be used. The material shall be as specified for type I bags. When type II bags are used, they shall be formed over a baseboard on a mandrel as specified in 5.1.1.1.1 before filling. While the bag is positioned on the mandrel, the two bag ears shall be taped down over a 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inch baseboard constructed in

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accordance with 5.1.1.1.2. An eight inch long strip of one inch wide tape complying with type III, class 2 of PPP-T-60, shall be applied across both ears to fasten them securely to the baseboard. Alternatively, both type I and type II mixing bags may be fabricated from unpigmented 0.003 inch thick high density 0.941 to 0.965 g/cm^3 food grade, flat polyethylene tubing. The bottom seal of type I and type II mixing bags, fabricated from clear polyethylene or the alternate polyethylene, shall be of adequate strength and integrity to withstand the addition of boiling water when tested in accordance with 4.5.1.4.

5.1.1.1.1 Mandrel. The mandrel face shall be 5-3/8 by 3-3/8 inches and the height shall be not less than 12 inches. All corners and edges of the mandrel shall be rounded and all surfaces finished to prevent damage to the bag material.

5.1.1.1.2 Baseboard. The baseboard shall be constructed from unbleached and uncoated solid sulfate or sulfite paperboard not less than 0.022 inch thick. Alternatively, the baseboard may be constructed from 0.022 inch thick food grade paperboard made from recycled fibers. If paperboard made from recycled fibers is used, it shall be natural color ranging from brown to grey. The baseboard shall be 5-1/2 by 3-1/2 inches (± 1/8 inch in each dimension) and shall have all corners rounded to form a smooth contour.

5.1.1.2 Barrier pouches. The pouch shall be constructed from a multiple ply, flexible laminate barrier material consisting of an outer ply of 0.0005 inch thick polyester bonded to an intermediate ply of 0.0007 inch thick aluminum foil with 10 pounds per ream pigmented polyethylene, and bonding the opposite side of the aluminum foil to 0.003 inch thick ionomer (inner ply) or a blend of not less than 50 percent linear, low density polyethylene and polyethylene. All tolerances for thickness of pouch materials shall be plus or minus 20 percent. The linear, low density polyethylene portion of the blend shall be the copolymer of ethylene and octene-1, having a melt index range of 0.8 to 1.2 g/10 minutes in accordance with ASTM D 1238 and a density range of 0.918 to 0.922 g/cm^3 in accordance with ASTM D 1505. For LRP applications, the complete exterior surface of the pouch shall be uniformly colored in the range of green 34079 through 34087 or 24052 through 24087 or brown 30045 through 30118 (excluding 30109) or 10045 of FED-STD-595. For RCW applications, the complete exterior surface of the pouch shall be colored white overall with a color in the range of 37778 through 37886 of FED-STD-595. The material shall be suitably formulated for food packaging and shall not impart an odor or flavor to the product being packaged. The material shall show no evidence of delamination, degradation, or foreign odor when heat sealed or fabricated into pouches.

5.1.1.2.1 Pouch construction. The pouch shall be a flat style preformed pouch having inside dimensions of 6 inches (± 1/8 inch) by 9 inches (± 1/8 inch). The first dimension specified shall be the opening of the pouch between the heat sealed sides. The empty pouch shall be made by heat sealing three edges with 3/8 inch (± 1/8 inch) wide seals. A "V", "C", or block "U" tear notch at least 1/32 inch deep located 1 to 1-1/4 inch from the top edge

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of the pouch, shall be made in one or both side seals. The distance between the inside edge of the tear notch and the inside edge of the seal shall be at least 3/16 inch. One side of the open end of the pouch may be provided with an extended or foldover lip, extended not more than 5/16 inch to facilitate opening and filling. Tear notch location shall be measured from the top of the pouch, excluding the extended or foldover lip. Alternatively, if the pouch has serrated edges, the serrations may be used as tear notches provided that the serrations are sharp (no plastic tailings exist) and the serrations depth and the minimum seal width at the serrated edges are in accordance with the above requirements. The pouch shall be constructed with square or rounded corners at all four corners (radius approximately 3/8 inch).

5.1.1.3 Pouch filling and sealing. The filled mixing bag specified in 5.1.1.2 shall be inserted into a pouch as specified in 5.1.1.3 in such a manner as to avoid puncturing the pouch material or contaminating the heat seal area. The filled pouches shall be sealed under a vacuum level of 23 inches of mercury. The sealed pouch shall show no loss of vacuum when examined as specified in 4.5.5. The filled pouch shall have a 3/8 inch ($\pm$ 1/8 inch) heat seal. If a thermal impulse closure seal is used, a seal width of 1/8 inch to 7/16 inch will be acceptable. When tested as specified in 4.5.7, the filled and sealed pouches shall withstand an internal pressure of 14 psig for 30 seconds without rupture or seal separation greater than 1/16 inch or seal separation that reduces the effective closure seal width to less than 1/16 inch. The closure seal shall not extend below the tear notch on either side of the pouch. The closure seal shall be free of fold over wrinkles that reduce the effective closure seal to less than 1/16 inch.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level C.

5.2.1 Level C packing. Not more than 40 pounds of pouched product shall be packed flat in a fiberboard box constructed and closed in accordance with style RSC-L, class domestic, variety SW, grade 200 of PPP-B-636. Cushioning material not less than 1/8 inch thick, conforming to grade II, class B or C of A-A-1898 or cushioning material not less than 1/16 inch thick, conforming to type I of PPP-C-1797 or cushioning material conforming to type 7, class 1 of PPP-C-1752 shall be placed between each of the layers and in the bottom and top of the box to minimize movement of the individual packages.

5.3 Unit loads. When specified (see 6.1), the product packed as specified in 5.2.1 shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified. When unit loads are strapped, the strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping.

5.4 Labeling and marking.

5.4.1 Pouches. Each pouch shall be clearly printed or stamped, in a manner that does not damage the pouch, with permanent black ink which is free of carcinogenic elements or ingredients. The information shall be located on the body of the pouch not closer than 1/16 inch to any seal. All pouches

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shall be coded. If a non-contact type printer is used, the information may be located anywhere on the pouch (in one complete print), except the closure seal area. The label shall contain the following information:

BEEF WITH RICE, COOKED, DEHYDRATED
(letters not less than 7/32 inch high)
ADD 10-12 OUNCES OF HOT WATER (APPROXIMATELY 1/2 CANTEEN CUP) TO MIXING BAG. STIR, WAIT APPROXIMATELY 5 MINUTES.
HOT WATER MAY BE ADDED IN STAGES TO KEEP FOOD HOT.
(letters not less than 1/8 inch high)

Ingredients
(letters not less than 3/32 inch high)
Date 1/
(letters not less than 1/8 inch high)
Net weight
(letters not less than 1/8 inch high)
Official establishment number (for example, EST-38/USDA stamp)
(letters not less than 1/8 inch high)
Contractor's name and address
(letters not less than 1/8 inch high)

1/ Each pouch shall have the date of pack noted by using a four digit code beginning with the final digit of the current year followed by the three digit Julian day code. For example, March 19, 1991 would read 1079. The Julian day code shall represent the date the product is unit packed into the pouch.

5.4.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4.3 Unit load marking. Unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-L-35078.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents should specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.4, and 6.2).
d. Provisions for approved preproduction samples (see 3.7.3 and 6.2).
e. Type and class of unit load when loading is required (see 5.3).
f. Ration, Cold Weather or Long Range Patrol component.

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6.2 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) 52.209-4. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer also should include specific instructions in all acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.3 Subject term (key word) listing.

Freeze dried
Long Range Patrol
Pouched food
Ration, Cold Weather
Shelf stable food

6.4 Changes from previous issue. Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 50

Review activities:

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

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I RECOMMEND A CHANGE:	1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT DATE (YYMMDD)
	MIL-B-43750H	1993 September 10

3. DOCUMENT TITLE
BEEF WITH RICE, COOKED, DEHYDRATED

4. NATURE OF CHANGE (Identify paragraph number and include proposed rewrite, if possible. Attach extra sheets as needed.)

5. REASON FOR RECOMMENDATION

6. SUBMITTER

a. NAME (Last, First, Middle Initial)	b. ORGANIZATION	
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code)	d. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code) (1) Commercial (2) AUTOVON (If applicable)	7. DATE SUBMITTED (YYMMDD)

8. PREPARING ACTIVITY

a. NAME	b. TELEPHONE (Include Area Code)	
U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center	(1) Commercial 508-651-4501	(2) AUTOVON/DSN 256-4501
c. ADDRESS (Include Zip Code) Commander, U.S. Army Natick RD&E Center ATTN: SATNC-WT Natick, MA 01760-5018	IF YOU DO NOT RECEIVE A REPLY WITHIN 45 DAYS, CONTACT: Defense Quality and Standardization Office 5203 Leesburg Pike, Suite 1403, Falls Church, VA 22041-3466 Telephone (703) 756-2340 AUTOVON 289-2340	

DD Form 1426, OCT 89 NATICK OP4, JUL 91 Previous editions are obsolete. 198/290

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